AI Max for Search

Product Overview



Microsoft Advertising

AI Max: Why now

Helping you **stay ahead of the curve** as Search evolves toward more AI-driven experiences.

REACH

Search is evolving, and every day brings new intent-driven queries we've never seen before. Advertisers need smarter solutions to reach them.

RELEVANCE

Traditional keywords and ads struggle to stay relevant in the face of new trends, long-tail queries, and emerging Search experiences.

RESULTS

Microsoft AI can help you connect with new customers throughout their journey and deliver ads that drive stronger results – without adding manual work.

AI Max: What you gain

This optional campaign toggle helps your Search campaigns deliver greater **reach**, more **relevance**, and stronger **results** – all powered by Microsoft AI.

01

Expand reach beyond your keyword list with AI-powered search term matching that uses your provided content to uncover incremental queries and conversion opportunities.

02

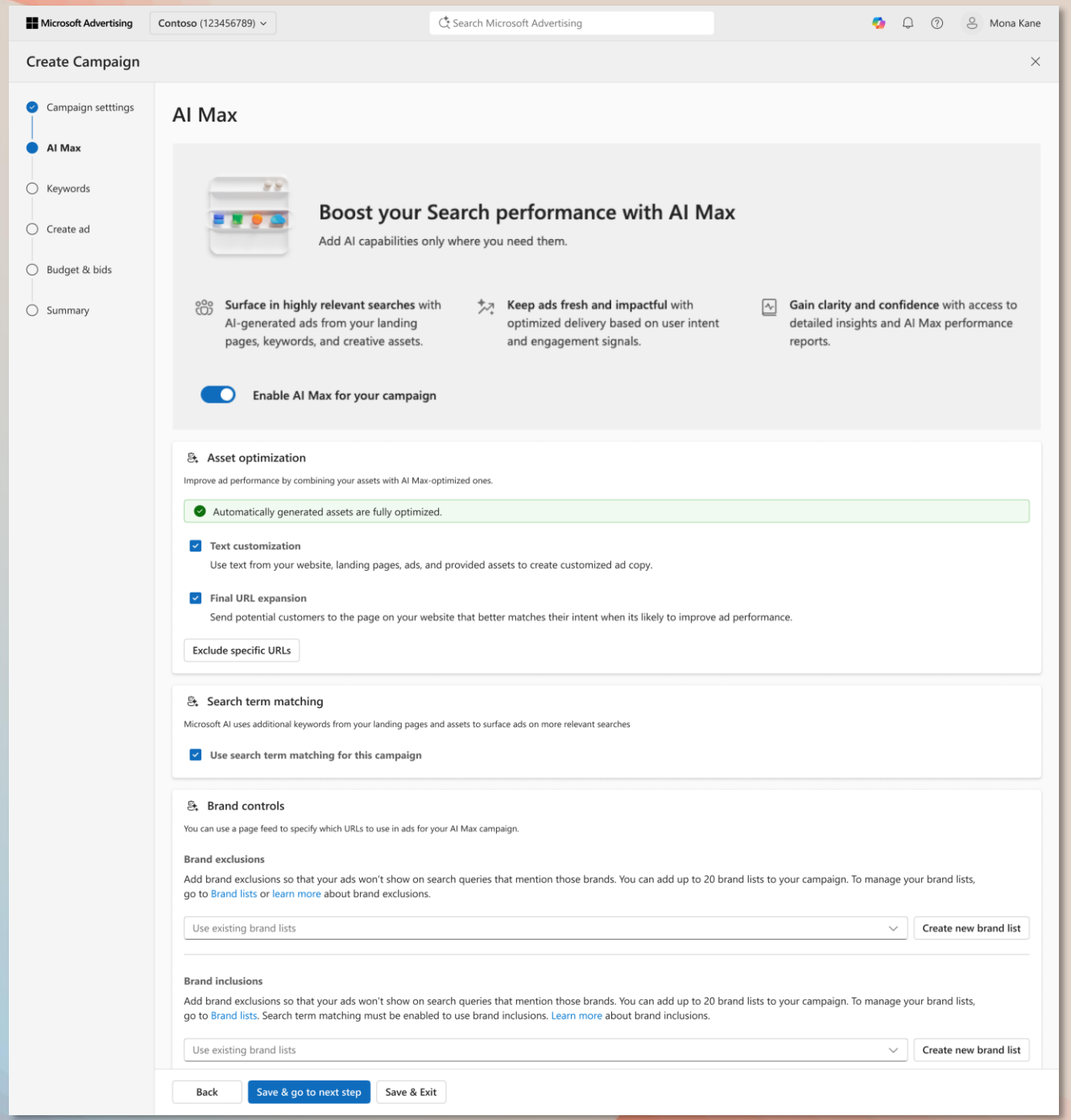
Create relevant, personalized creative at scale through dynamic text customization, ensuring relevance without manual overhead.

03

Optimize destinations for better results by intelligently expanding final URLs and routing traffic to the most relevant landing page, improving conversion rates and user experience.

Product overview

AI Max is an **optional** Search campaign feature that uses the best of Microsoft AI to dynamically match ads to relevant searches by using advertiser-provided content and real-time signals.



In early tests, advertisers saw at least an

8%

increase in conversions with Microsoft AI Max versus control Search campaigns with AI Max disabled.

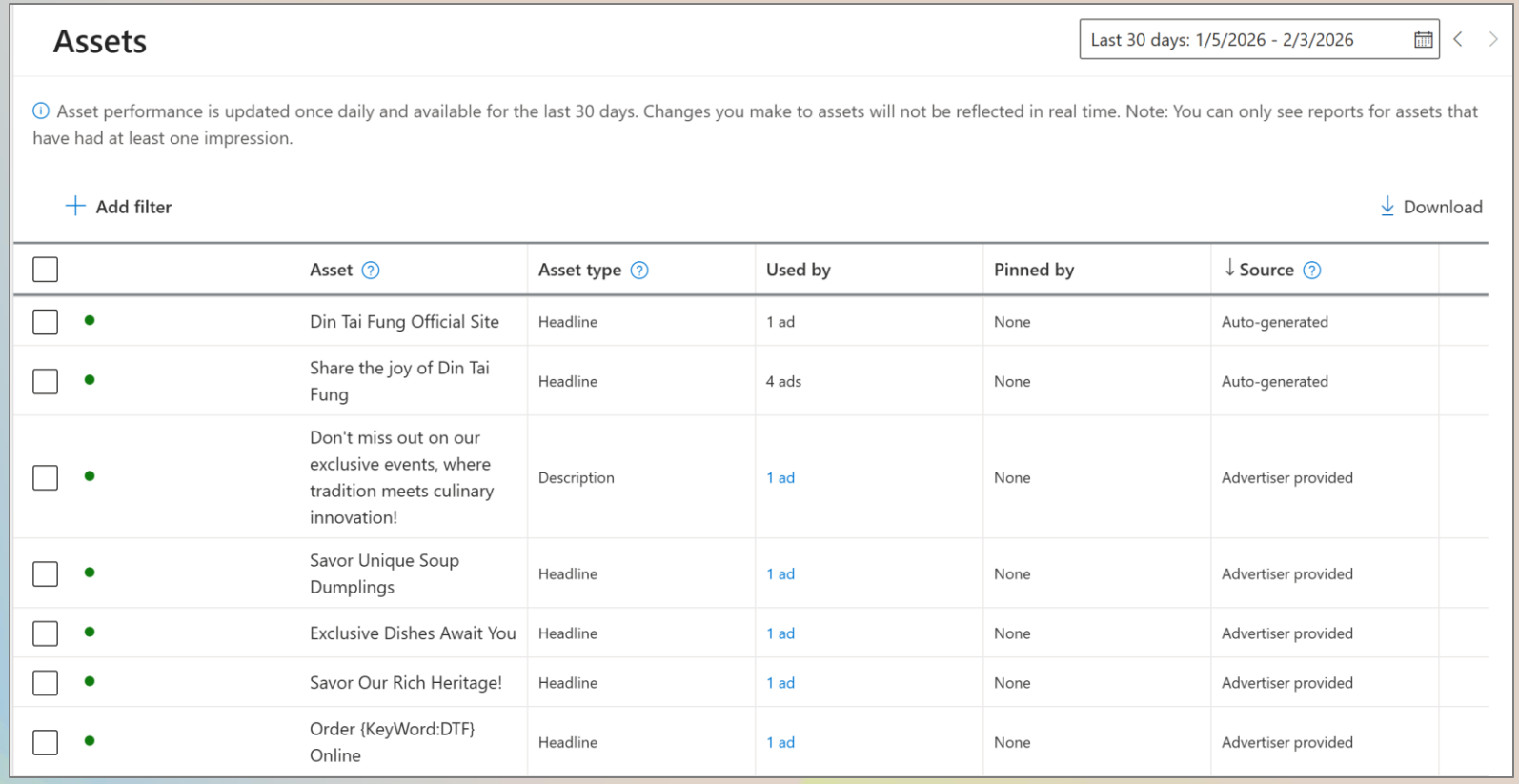
For campaigns relying more heavily on Exact and Phrase match keywords, the observed uplift was higher.



Reporting

You'll have full visibility into how AI Max is driving performance in your campaigns – including assets, keywords, search terms, and final URLs.

Creative asset reporting



Assets

Last 30 days: 1/5/2026 - 2/3/2026

Asset performance is updated once daily and available for the last 30 days. Changes you make to assets will not be reflected in real time. Note: You can only see reports for assets that have had at least one impression.

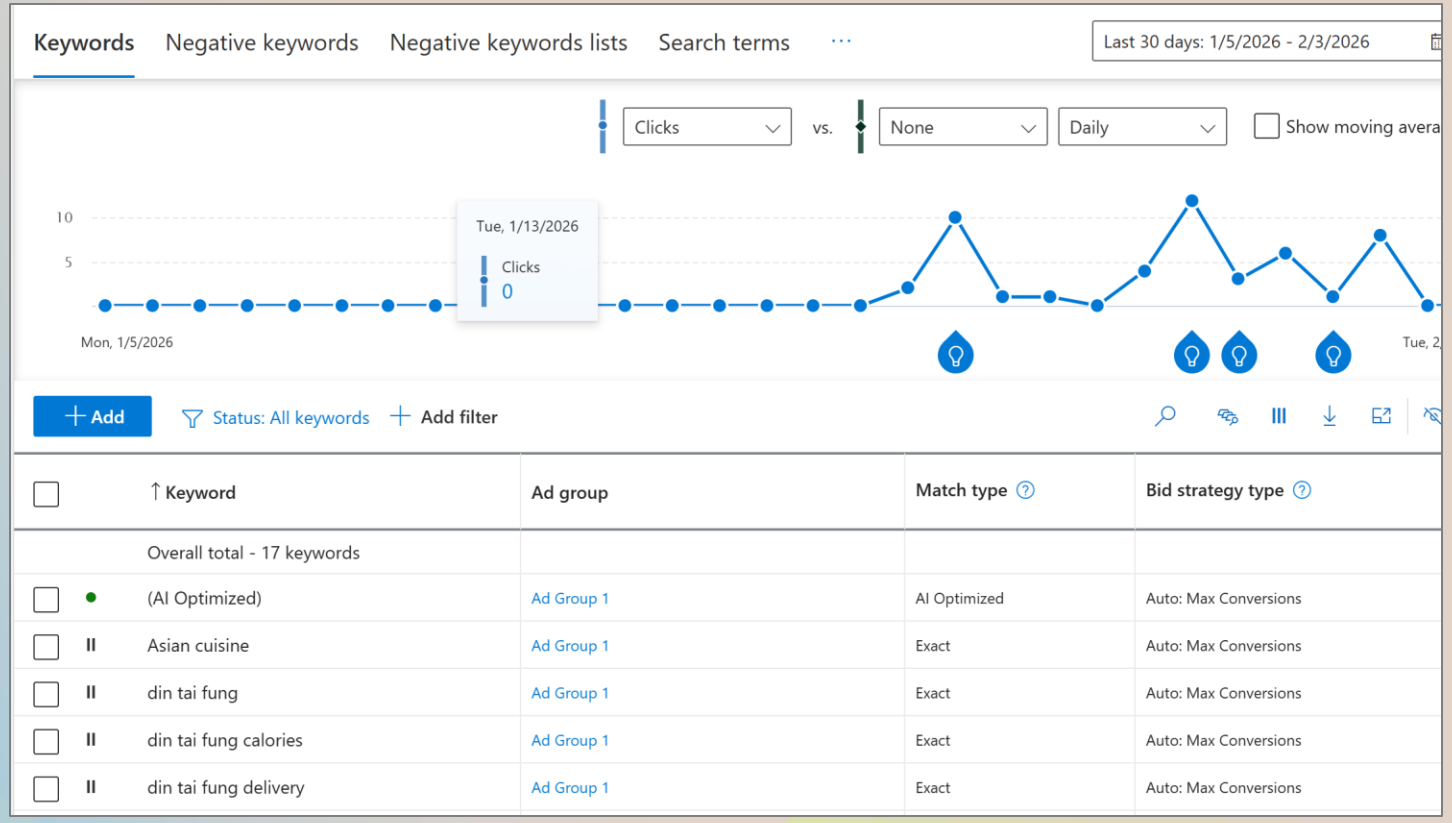
Add filter | Download

Asset	Asset type	Used by	Pinned by	Source
Din Tai Fung Official Site	Headline	1 ad	None	Auto-generated
Share the joy of Din Tai Fung	Headline	4 ads	None	Auto-generated
Don't miss out on our exclusive events, where tradition meets culinary innovation!	Description	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided
Savor Unique Soup Dumplings	Headline	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided
Exclusive Dishes Await You	Headline	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided
Savor Our Rich Heritage!	Headline	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided
Order {KeyWord:DTF} Online	Headline	1 ad	None	Advertiser provided

Reporting

You'll have full visibility into how AI Max is driving performance in your campaigns – including assets, keywords, search terms, and final URLs.

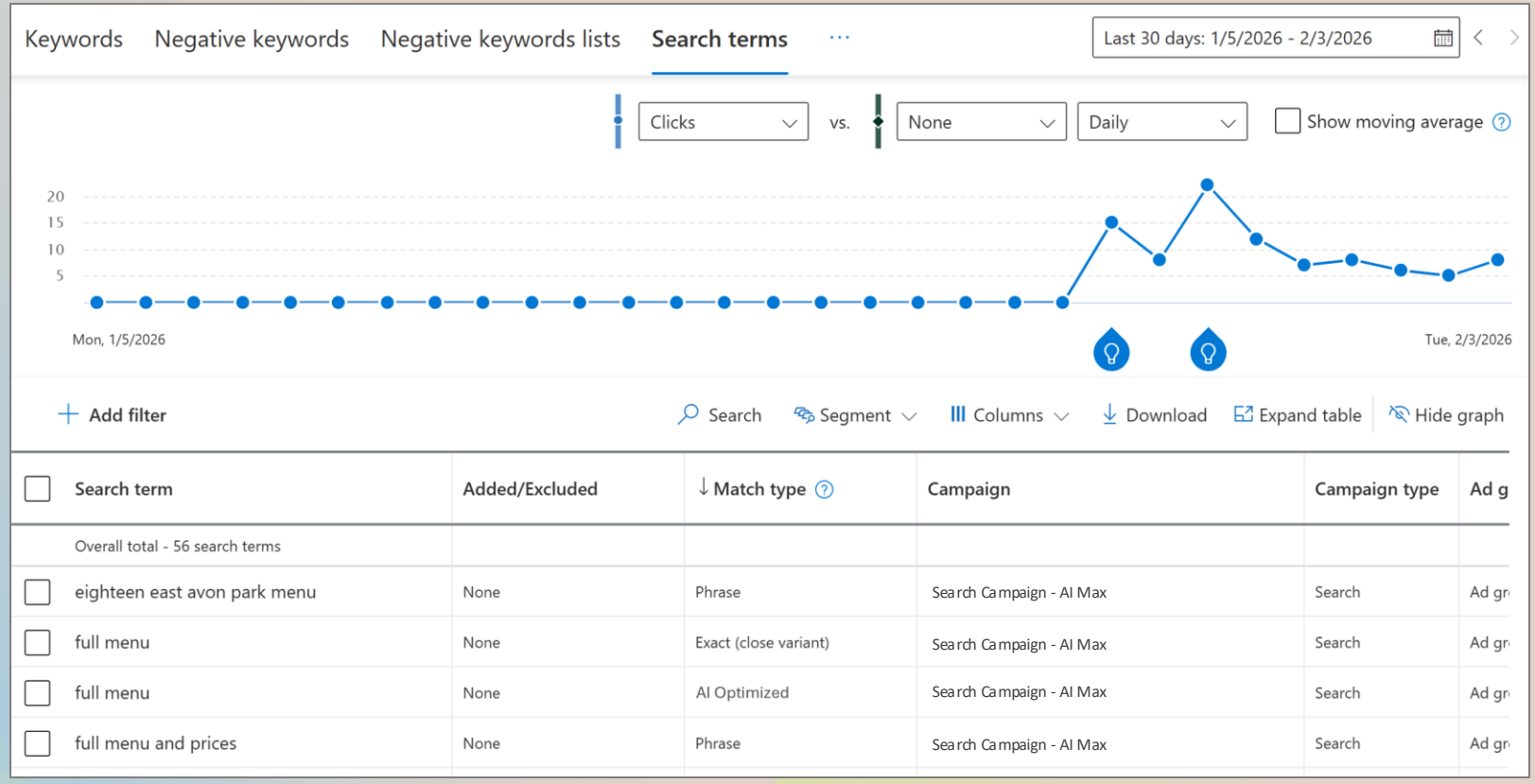
Keyword reporting



Reporting

You'll have full visibility into how AI Max is driving performance in your campaigns – including assets, keywords, search terms, and final URLs.

Search term reporting

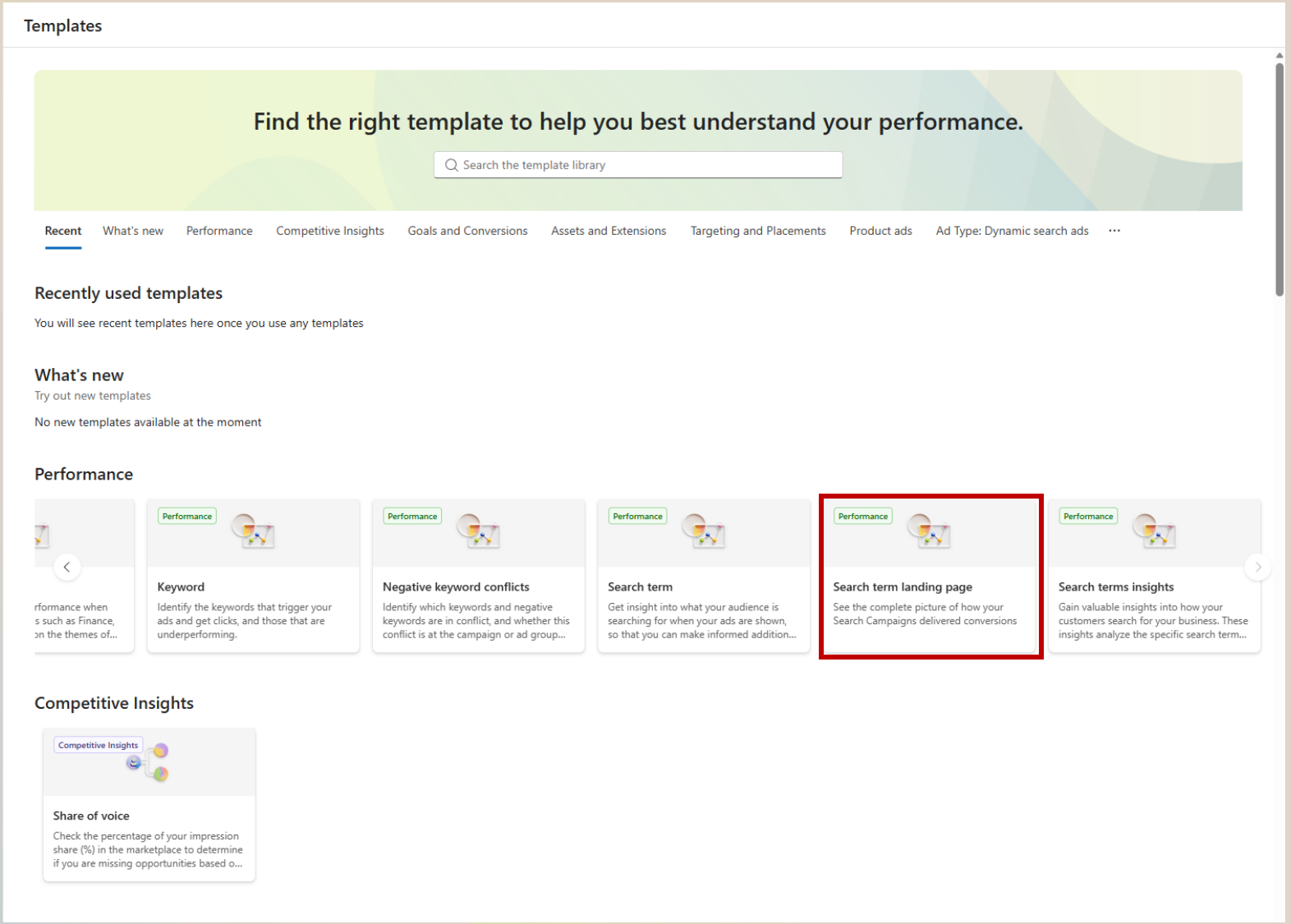


Reporting

The **search term landing page report** is available as a downloadable report template.

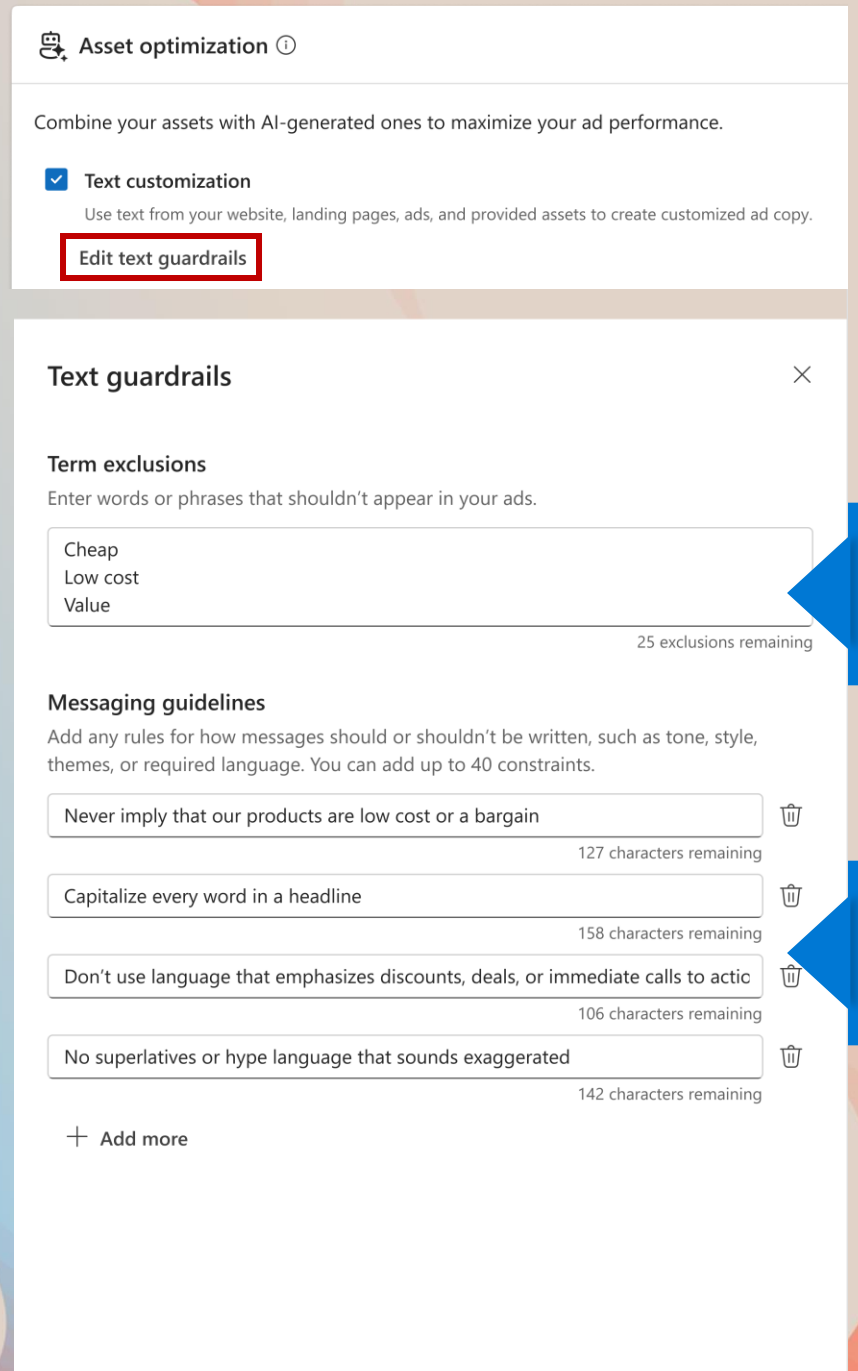
It can help you understand how customer searches connect to landing pages and conversions, all in a single report.

Search term landing page reporting



Creative controls

With **Term exclusions** and **Messaging guidelines**, you'll be able to shape AI-generated assets using both direct and prompt-based guidelines – keeping your creative aligned with your brand and messaging goals.



Term exclusions are exact terms you want to block from ad copy. Add up to **25**.

Messaging guidelines are prompt-based messaging and formatting guardrails for ad copy. Add up to **40**.

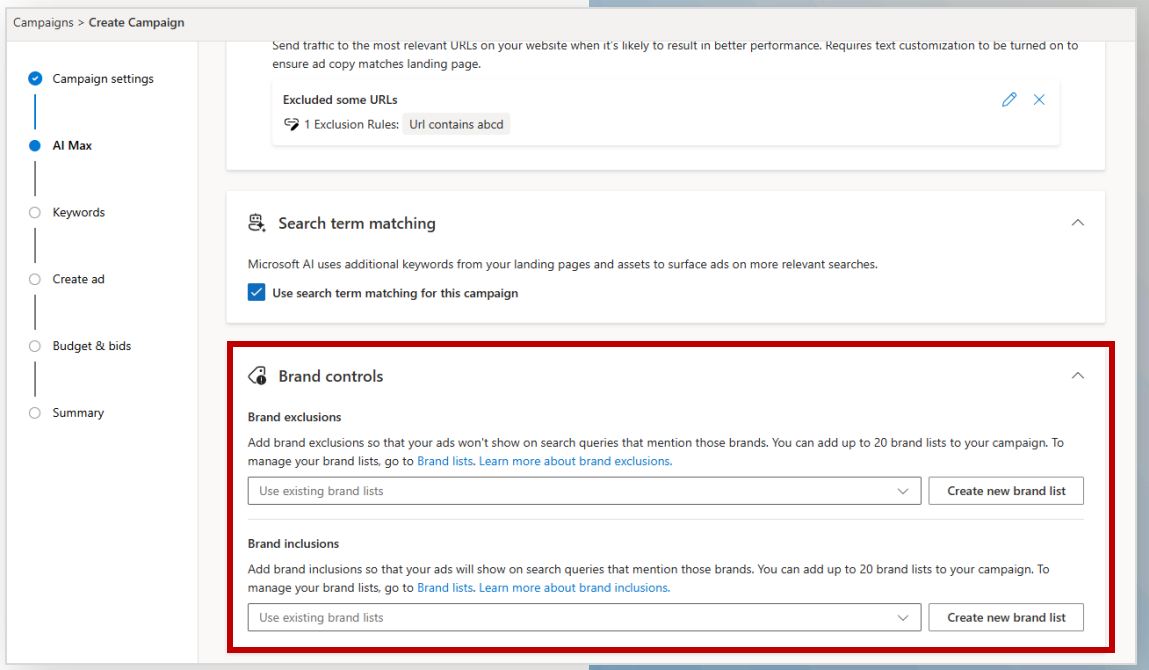
Brand controls

Controls here apply to **all** Search traffic, not just AI Max – giving you automation without losing the guardrails.

Precision brand safety, built into AI Max

Decide exactly which brands your ads can – and can't – show against, without giving up AI-powered reach.

You can have **20** brand lists in an account with **100** brands per list; **20** lists can be applied per campaign.



Brand inclusions

Limit a campaign to serve on queries tied to the brands you name. Can **only** be used when STM is enabled.

Brand exclusions

Keep your ads off competitor or off-limits brand terms – automatically. Can be used at **any** time.

Account-level lists

Build brand lists once and scale them across campaigns.

Product timeline

AUGUST 19TH, 2026

General availability

- *MAP and API supported*
- *Google Import supported*
- *External documentation ready (Help Center, API)*

FEATURES

Search term matching

Text customization

Final URL expansion

Search experiments

Brand controls

Term exclusions

GA AND BEYOND

Ongoing updates

- *High-demand features to be added based on your feedback*

FEATURES

Messaging guidelines (in pilot)

URL inclusions (rolling out)

Product availability

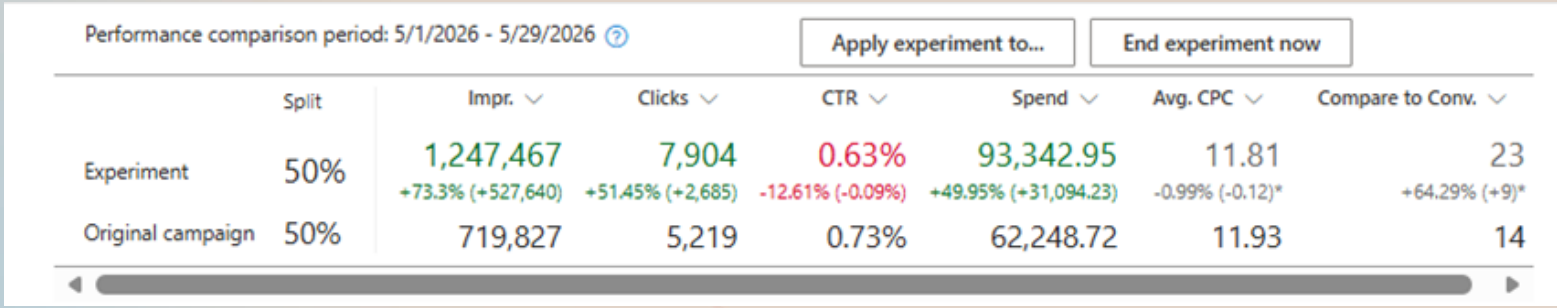
	STATUS	MARKETS	ENTRY POINTS	DEVICE	TRAFFIC
AI MAX	General availability	Global (excl. China)	Online	All devices	Search (incl. Search Partners, Search Workflows)

Experiments for AI Max

The following slides cover common implementation. Full details are available in the feature guide for Campaign Experiments-Search Campaigns.

Search Experiments with AI Max

Set up and run a **Search Experiment** to statistically measure the performance lift of enabling AI Max for your Search campaign.



Experiments: Best Practices



Campaign Selection

- Use high-volume campaigns when possible, otherwise experiments may require a longer duration to reach statistical significance.
- Campaigns using shared or lifetime budgets are currently **not** supported.
- A campaign cannot participate in multiple active experiments at the same time.



Traffic Split

- Use a 50/50 traffic split to gather volume quickly and make comparisons easier.
- Make sure to select the Cookie-based split option, not Search-based.
- Experiment traffic split cannot be changed once an experiment is running.
- Results are automatically normalized so you can compare treatment (clicks, conversions, conversion value, cost, and impressions) and control fairly.



Experiment Launch

- Test only one variable at a time (AI Max only).
- Run A/B mode for at least 2 weeks (ideally 4 weeks).

Experiments: Setup

How to set up and run a Search Experiment for AI Max.

01

Create experiment and treatment campaign

Create a Search Experiment and select the control campaign (original Search campaign) and the experiment start and end dates. **The treatment campaign is automatically created** as a copy of the control campaign.

02

Apply changes & run A/B test

For the treatment Search campaign, go into the campaign settings and enable AI Max. Let the experiment run over the next 2-4 weeks and review the experiment scorecard results during this period.

03

Review results & take action

You may end the experiment at any time. If results show a lift with AI Max enabled, you can apply the experiment to either the original or a new (treatment) Search campaign.

04

For more info:

Discover the possibilities with experiments

Examples and tips for working with experiments

Frequently Asked Questions

The following questions address common concerns raised in product discussions.

QUESTION

What does AI Max do – and what problems does it solve?

ANSWER

AI Max is an optional feature layer for Search campaigns that uses Microsoft AI to dynamically match ads to relevant searches, personalize creative assets, and intelligently route users to the most relevant landing page on your website. It can help you:

- Reach more high-intent customers.
- Deliver personalized ad experiences at scale.
- Improve campaign reach, efficiency, and conversion rates.
- Get better campaign outputs for your time investment.
- Maintain transparency and control with brand inclusion and exclusion tools.

QUESTION

How does Microsoft's AI Max differ from Google's AI Max?

ANSWER

Microsoft's AI Max is our equivalent to Google's AI Max—**but they aren't identical**.

Google AI Max expands matching and creative automation using Google's signals. Microsoft's AI Max does something similar, but with the benefit of unique first-party data from Bing, Edge, and LinkedIn, plus more built-in transparency from the very start.

Both improve reach and relevance, but our offering was built specifically for advertisers who want automation without losing insight or control over search-only traffic.

QUESTION

What features are found in Microsoft's AI Max versus Google's AI Max?

Feature	Google AI Max	Microsoft AI Max
Core automation *(Search term matching, text customization, final URL expansion)*	✅	✅
Keyword reporting	✅	✅
Search term reporting	✅	✅
Asset reporting *(Auto vs. provided)*	✅	✅
Landing page asset reporting	✅	✅
Search term landing page reporting	✅	✅
Conversion-based bidding	✅	✅
Non-conversion based bidding	✅	⏳
Portfolio bidding	✅	✅
Ad group-level controls	✅	⏳
Brand inclusions & exclusions	✅	✅
Term exclusions	✅	✅
Messaging guidelines	✅	⏳
Pinned asset support	⚠️	⚠️

QUESTION

How does AI Max differ from Performance Max?

ANSWER

AI Max is an optional feature layer that brings automation into standard Search campaigns, whereas Performance Max is a cross-channel campaign type. AI Max is designed to expand matching, personalize creative, and route users to the most relevant landing page, all while maintaining the control and transparency you expect from standard Search campaigns. It is not a new campaign type like Performance Max, nor is it a "black box." It augments Search campaigns rather than replacing them.

If you're mainly focused on maximizing Search and are looking for a balance of control and automation, AI Max is ideal for your Search campaigns. For maximum reach and automation across all of Microsoft's channels, use Performance Max.

QUESTION

How can I test the impact of AI Max?

ANSWER

We recommend you try using an experiment, which are fully supported. Follow these steps to set one up:

- Create a Search Experiment and select the Search campaign you want to test with AI Max.
- Launch the experiment and let it run for up to 4 weeks to allow the cloned Search campaign to ramp up.
- For the cloned Search campaign, go into the campaign's settings and enable AI Max.
- You can end the experiment at any time. If the experiment shows a positive lift, you can apply it to either your original or cloned campaign.

QUESTION

What bidding strategies are supported?

ANSWER

AI Max currently supports conversion-based bid strategies at the individual campaign level, such as Maximize Conversions (with Target CPA) and Maximize Conversion Value (with Target ROAS). It does not support enhanced CPC, manual bidding, or click-based bid strategies.

In addition, while AI Max **does** support portfolio bidding strategies, using them is not recommended as a best practice due to how it may affect measurement and campaign optimization behaviors.

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Thank you



Appendix

The following slides cover common implementation and control questions. Full details are available in the main FAQ.

QUESTION

Will enabling AI Max have any impact on my eligibility or likelihood to show within Copilot?

ANSWER

AI Max does not *directly* determine Copilot eligibility or ranking today. It strengthens Search campaign relevance and adaptability to evolving consumer behavior, which supports performance across emerging AI-driven surfaces over time by helping campaigns stay resilient as queries become more conversational, compressed, and intent-rich.

AI Max focuses on improving Search performance by expanding matching, enhancing creative relevance, and selecting stronger landing pages. While these improvements may indirectly help your campaigns become more competitive overall, there is no dedicated prioritization, eligibility boost, or guaranteed increase in Copilot impressions tied to enabling the feature.

QUESTION

How will Google Import work with AI Max?

ANSWER

Google Import will bring over your Google AI Max campaign-level settings 1:1 with their corresponding Microsoft AI Max features. However, there are specific things to note here:

1. If you use scheduled Google Imports and have Google AI Max enabled in the source account, **Microsoft's AI Max will be enabled after the next import sync**. Advertisers are not otherwise automatically opted in to AI Max.
2. Google AI Max's search term matching feature can also work at the ad group level. **If a single ad group has this feature enabled, the entire campaign will inherit that setting**. You'll have the option to turn it off while importing if you wish to do so.

Additional questions

Answers to common technical questions you may have.

Can I still use negative keywords?

Yes. You'll retain standard control of your Search traffic via negative keywords. Existing negatives won't be overridden and can still be used as a way of removing less relevant traffic.

What controls do I retain, and what do I give up?

You'll still have control over your targeting preferences via negatives and placement exclusions, but we'll expand your keywords, optimize creative and redirect users to optimal landing pages to increase conversion uplift.

How are pinned assets handled?

We will not honor pinned assets when final URL expansion is enabled, as doing so can lead to a mismatch in landing page and ad copy that could negatively impact performance.

Why can I not use final URL expansion without text customization?

Optimizing ad assets based on the content of your website is key to delivering a cohesive experience – your existing, static assets may not work as well with an optimized landing page.